



EPIC PROGRAM · 2026 COHORT

CLOSED BY CLAUDE.

A vibe-coded, AI-native financial close platform — built by the EPiC cohort.

Close Tracker

Reconciliation

Reporting

 Powered by Claude AI · Anthropic

CAPSTONE
NE
PROJECT
2026
BRIEF

WHY WE'RE BUILDING THIS.

Closed by Claude isn't just a cohort project. It's a Pioneer product — and these are the five reasons it matters right now.

01

Gateway to our low-code / no-code practice

This is the entry point into Pioneer's portfolio of AI-native, vibe-coded tools. It proves we can deliver functional software without traditional dev resources — opening the door to strategy work and more complex AI/ML engagements downstream.

02

Finance transformation is a massive, underserved opportunity

Month-end close is still run on spreadsheets and email chains at most mid-market companies. The process is broken and expensive. Clients are asking for help — and Pioneer needs a credible, demonstrable point of view to win that work.

03

A real product to show Anthropic

Pioneer is developing a partnership with Anthropic. Nothing accelerates that conversation faster than a live product. Closed by Claude is a polished, client-ready demo showing how Claude gets applied in the enterprise.

04

Trains the cohort in AI-native delivery

The EPiC cohort will enter engagements where AI fluency is expected, not optional. Building a real tool with Claude — not just reading about it — is the fastest path to hands-on expertise that makes Pioneer consultants stand out.

05

Creates a repeatable Pioneer IP asset

A well-built version becomes a Pioneer asset — packaged, branded, and deployable to clients in the Adopt phase. It's also a proof point for future AI & finance transformation proposals.



Build a vibe-coded, AI-native financial close platform — from checklist to reporting — using Claude as your development partner.

PROJECT SUMMARY

What is it? A fully functional AI-powered financial close application, built end-to-end by your cohort using Claude as both developer and AI engine.

Why it matters? Finance teams lose hundreds of hours per close cycle to manual tracking, disconnected handoffs, and spreadsheet reconciliation. This tool eliminates that.

The challenge: Three integrated modules. One cohesive tool. Zero legacy software.

DELIVERABLES

- Working application — demo ready
- Go-To-Market Plan
- 5-min cohort presentation + live demo
- 1-page write-up on AI prompting approach

ANTICIPATED Q&A

- Q: Do I need to code?** No — Claude writes the code. You direct it.
- Q: What stack?** Claude and Azure for data storage.
- Q: Real financial data required?** Sample data provided
- Q: Can we use a template?** Yes — but Claude must drive the build.

RESOURCES & SAMPLE DATA

📄 Sample P&L Statement (Excel)

📄 Sample Balance Sheet (Excel)

📄 Financial Data File (Cohort Use)

📄 Claude API Docs

01

Close Tracker

Checklist & Agentic Workflow Engine

A real-time close management hub giving finance teams a living checklist, status visibility, and automated handoffs across dependent tasks.

STARTING REQUIREMENTS

Checklist engine	Dynamic task list with owner assignments, due dates, status flags (Not started / In progress / Complete / Blocked), and priority tagging.
Reminders & escalation	Automated reminders when tasks are overdue. Escalation logic surfaces blockers to team leads automatically.
Agentic data handoffs	Claude-powered agents pass data between dependent workflow steps — e.g., once TB is locked, auto-trigger reconciliation tasks downstream.
Dependency mapping	Visual dependency graph showing linear task chains. Blocked tasks flagged with root cause (upstream owner/step).
Close calendar	Month-end / quarter-end calendar overlaid on task list. Tracks days-to-close with historical benchmarking.

02

Reconciliation Module

Account Tie-Out & Variance Analysis

An intelligent reconciliation workspace where finance staff upload an Excel file and Claude helps identify variances, flag unexplained items, and sign off on balances.

STARTING REQUIREMENTS

Excel import	Drag-and-drop upload of GL extract or subledger (.xlsx / .csv). Auto-map columns to standard fields.
Tie-out logic	Compare GL balance to supporting schedule. Surface reconciling items with suggested matches.
AI variance commentary	Claude analyzes unexplained differences and generates plain-language explanations, with prompts for preparer to confirm or override.
Sign-off workflow	Preparer and reviewer sign-off at account level. Signed-off recs are locked. Status rolls up to the Close Tracker automatically.
Rec template library	Pre-built templates for common accounts: cash, prepaids, accruals, intercompany, fixed assets.

03

Reporting Module

P&L and Balance Sheet Output

Automated financial statement generation — pulling from reconciled data to produce a formatted P&L and Balance Sheet with AI-generated commentary and variance analysis.

STARTING REQUIREMENTS

P&L statement	Formatted income statement with revenue, COGS, gross margin, OpEx, EBITDA, and net income. Configurable by entity and period.
Balance sheet	Full balance sheet (assets / liabilities / equity) tied to reconciled account balances. Highlights accounts not yet signed off.
Variance vs. prior period	Side-by-side comparison to prior month and prior year with \$ and % change. Color-coded for favorable / unfavorable movements.
AI narrative	Claude generates a plain-language CFO commentary paragraph based on the actual numbers — e.g., 'Revenue increased 12% MoM driven by...'
Export & share	Export to formatted Excel or PDF. Shareable link generates a read-only view for stakeholders outside the close team.